

Maoz Tzur

402b

Version 1

Trad/Benedetto Marcello
Arr. Stuart Izon

Compared to the more well known melody, this Italian Ashkenazic setting is much older, and is arguably more authentically Jewish. It was transcribed and repurposed in the 1720s by the eminent composer Benedetto Marcello for his setting of Psalm 16, "Signor dall'empia gente". Marcello was a Christian aristocrat, politician and composer who became obsessed with ancient melodies, and believed that the Hebrew themes he arranged originally derived from the Temple in Jerusalem. Marcello's scores are some of the earliest existing Jewish musical notation, long before use of Western style music notation was commonplace. In his score he includes the text of Maoz Tzur in Hebrew along with the inscription "The intonation of the German Jews" i.e. Ashkenazi Jews who lived in Venice at the time.

Andantino

Melody Alto

Ma - oz tzur y' - shu - a - ti l' - cha - na - e l' - sha - bei - ach

Tenor Bass

5

M A

ti - kon beit t' - fi - la - ti v' - sham to - da n' - za - bei - ach l' -

T B

9

M A

-eit ta - chin mat - bei - ach mi - tzar ha - m' - na - bei - ach

T B

13

M
A

8

az_____ eg-mor_ b'-shir miz - mor_ cha - nu - kat ha-miz - bei - ach

az eg-mor b'-shir miz - mor_____ cha - nu - kat ha-miz - bei - ach

T
B